



RED BANNER ALERT

mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident	8 February 2024	Time of Incident	19:55
Directorate / Region	RMO – Great Southern Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	37689
Actual Consequence	Major	Potential Consequence	Catastrophic

Incident Short Description	MoP has failed to stop at a Vehicle Control Point, collided with a Fire Services vehicle and then impacted a Traffic Controller.
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What Happened

Main Roads was providing a manned Vehicle Control Point (VCP) for the Green Range bushfire road closure at the intersection of South Coast Hwy and Cheyne Beach Road. The VCP was located east of the intersection.

At approximately 19:55 a Member of Public (MoP) travelling westbound from the fire incident side of the VCP has driven through the road closure point without stopping. The MoP collided with a Fire Services Fast Attack Vehicle, and then struck a contractor Traffic Controller (TC).

The Traffic Control vehicle was parked on the left side of the road heading east (north side of the road) on the shadow side of the closure signs, with flashing lights on; it was dark after sunset when the collision occurred. The road section east of the VCP is straight on an improved section of road with good sight distance.

The Fire Services crews on scene immediately called 000, requested assistance, and provided first aid where possible. Police and Fire & Rescue attended the scene and extracted the MoP driver from their vehicle. Injured persons were conveyed to the Albany Hospital, and the MoP driver transferred to Perth with head injuries. The VCP point was relocated west of the intersection.

The TC was assessed at hospital, confirming right hand laceration/bruising and an ankle fracture; the fracture was treated with a cast and no surgery was required. A second (uninjured) TC was escorted from the scene to their home in Albany and accessed the contractor Employee Assistance Program (EAP) for trauma counselling. Preliminary advice suggests the Fire Services Officer in the impacted Fast Attack Vehicle sustained cervical spine injuries (details to be confirmed).

A WorkSafe injury notification has been made.



Vehicle positions after the incident. The VCP was relocated west of the intersection post-incident.

A formal investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Interaction with Live Traffic**.

Distribution of Notice	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations
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